After a detailed analysis of the available options, I chose a fibreglass motor casing. We decided in favour of a composite propel ant which gives a higher specific impulse and aimed at a longer burning time to utilize it completely. I also decided to take additional safety measures by incorporating a diaphragm which would rupture if the chamber pressure for some reason exceeded twice the operating pressure. Two significant developments occurred during the work on RATO. The first was the release of a ten-year profile for space research in the country, prepared by Prof. Sarabhai. This profile was not merely an activity plan laid down by the top man for his team to comply with, it was a theme paper meant for open discussions, to be later transformed into a programme. In fact, I found it was the romantic manifesto of a person deeply in love with the space research programme in his country.

The plan mainly centred around the early ideas which had been born at INCOSPAR; it included utilization of satel ites for television and developmental education, meteorological observations and remote sensing for management of natural resources. To this had been added the development and launch of satel ite launch vehicles.